



Recall our discussion of the question whether free will is compatible, or incompatible, with determinism.

Free will is a  
great good.

Even God could not  
have given us free  
will while ensuring  
that we never used  
that free will to  
bring about evil.

We have free  
will.

A good case can be made that the above assumption requires  
that free will be incompatible with determinism.

For suppose that free will was compatible with determinism.  
Then it may seem as if God could have determined us to freely  
choose the good on every occasion.

That, if you recall, was exactly Mackie's objection to the free will defense.

So a plausible argument can be made that the free will defense requires, not just that we have free will, but that Libertarianism be true. If you are a Compatibilist who endorses the free will defense, you should think about how you might respond to this argument.



replies to  
Libet

A large, solid red circle is centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the Libet experiments" is written in a white, sans-serif font, centered both horizontally and vertically.

the Libet  
experiments



is free will  
an important  
good?

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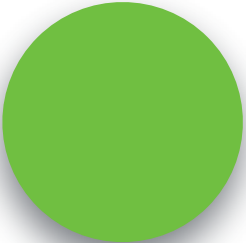
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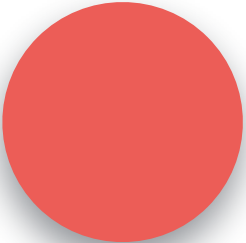


In ancient times, philosophers worried about the challenge to free will from fate. After

the birth of modern physics, many worried about the challenges it would bring from

will prosper by contemporary neuroscience.

determinism. Our topic today is much more recent challenge to free











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